

EDUCATIONPLUS

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John J. Kennedy

For decades, higher education across the globe sold a fairly standard dream: secure admission to a prestigious institution, earn a marketable degree, and move smoothly into employment. Rankings, brand value, and placement statistics were treated as proxies for success. However, the *Annual Student Quest Report 2025* released by the International College and Career Counselling (IC3) Institute suggests that today's students, across regions and socio-economic contexts, appear to be recalibrating what they expect from higher education and are prioritising well-being, safety, purpose, and long-term relevance over institutional prestige.

This shift reflects a generation coming of age amid overlapping crises: a pandemic that exposed mental health fragilities, economic uncertainty that unsettled linear career paths, rapid technological change that renders skills obsolete faster than degrees can certify them, and a global climate of anxiety shaped by conflict, climate change, and political instability. In such a context, it is hardly surprising that students ask a different set of questions: Will this institution protect my mental health? Will I feel safe here? Will my education have meaning beyond short-term employability?

However, this recalibration also exposes a trou-

bling gap between student expectations and institutional preparedness. While over 80% of students reportedly rely on AI-powered tools for career exploration and university selection, a significantly smaller proportion of counsellors use similar technologies. Even more telling is the finding that family members remain students' most trusted advisers. This reliance reflects both cultural realities and systemic inadequacies. Formal guidance structures in many countries, including India, remain under-resourced, sporadic, and exam-centric.

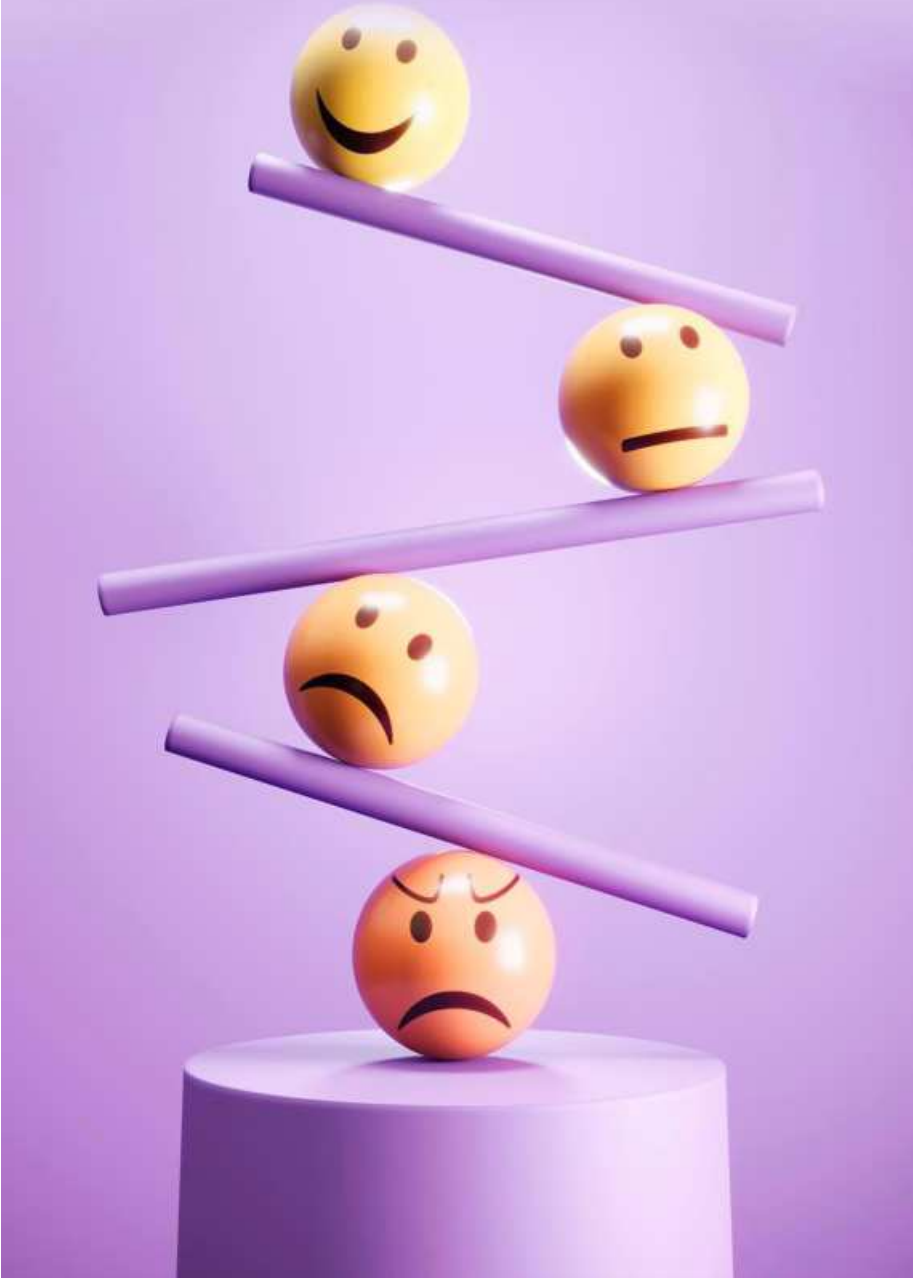
Have students thought this through fully? In part, yes. Their emphasis on well-being and purpose is backed by strong evidence linking mental health to academic success and life outcomes. But there is a danger in over-individualising responsibility. Student preferences alone cannot drive institutional change. The latter requires funding, trained personnel, and a radical shift in academic culture. Without these, well-being risks becoming a slogan rather than a reality.

Indian context

In India, these findings resonate with deep ongoing concerns. Indian campuses – both elite and state-run – continue to witness alarming reports of student stress, anxiety, and suicide. Competitive academic cultures, rigid evaluation systems, caste discrimination, financial

Mind over marks

Why student well-being matters as much as degrees



pressure, and inadequate psychological support form a combustible mix. Against this backdrop, students' insistence on safety and mental well-being is not a choice but a necessity.

However, the feasibility of implementing this student-centred vision in Indian higher education remains contested, primarily because capacity is uneven. While a handful of private and central institutions have begun investing in counselling centres, mentorship programmes, and flexible curricula, the vast majority struggle with basic staffing, infrastructure, and governance deficits. Often, inclination is missing. Mental health is still viewed as peripheral, remedial, or individual rather than institutional and preventive.

In this context, the IC3 report's call for "Counselling as a Culture" is significant. It suggests moving beyond token counsellor appointments towards embedding guidance within pedagogy, leadership practices, teacher training, and parental engagement. In India, this requires a decisive break from the exam-centric mindset that dominates schooling and higher education. Faculty members will need training not only in subject expertise but also in student mentorship and emotional literacy.

Additionally, government policy plays a critical role. Regulatory bodies such as the UGC must move beyond issuing advi-

sories and insist on enforceable standards for student support systems. Funding mechanisms should recognise counselling services, mental health infrastructure, and faculty development as core academic investments, not optional add-ons. Equally important is reducing structural stressors: unrealistic syllabi, compressed academic calendars, punitive assessment practices, and opaque grievance redressal mechanisms.

Institutions, for their part, must confront uncomfortable questions. Do they see students primarily as rank-holders and placement statistics, or as young adults navigating complex personal and social transitions? Are they willing to sacrifice a measure of performative excellence to create humane academic environments? Without such introspection, well-being will remain a policy buzzword rather than an institutional ethic.

The IC3 report has revealed not a fragile generation, as critics often claim, but a discerning one. Today's students appear to understand that education divorced from purpose and well-being is neither sustainable nor meaningful. The question is: are Indian HEIs willing to meet them even halfway? That may well determine its relevance in the years to come.

The writer is former Professor and Dean, Christ University, Bengaluru.

SCHOLARSHIPS

Rajiv Gandhi University Internship

Provided by the Rajiv Gandhi University, Arunachal Pradesh
Eligibility: Students enrolled in a Social Sciences UG/ PG programme
Rewards: Certificate and benefits.
Application: Online
Deadline: May 15
www.b4s.in/edge/RGAU1

The Cadence/Invecas Scholarship

From Cadence Design Systems and Concern India Foundation
Eligibility: Students from lower-income groups with minimum 80% overall in Class 12 who live and study in Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Pune, Ahmedabad, and Hyderabad only.
Rewards: Support for key educational expenses.
Application: Online
Deadline: May 10
www.b4s.in/edge/TCSP6

The Einstein Fellowship

From the Einstein Forum and the Wittenstein Foundation.
Eligibility: Individuals below 35 years with a degree in the Humanities, Social Sciences, or Natural Sciences and interested in pursuing research in a different field.
Rewards: €10,000
Application: Online
Deadline: May 15
www.b4s.in/edge/TEFG1

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

What interests you?

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

I finished B.Com. and Taxation in 2025. I am not great at academics, nor do I have any exceptionally good skills. Having a B.Com. degree makes everything worse. I don't know what to do. Name withheld on request.

Your degree is not your destination; it is merely the start line. You have the foundation of accounting, tax, and basic finance. Now, you need to find the one thing that you enjoy doing, that also pays well, and get better at it, one day at a time.

Since you did Taxation, consider high-demand roles such as accounts executive, ERP support, or financial analyst. Do online courses in accounting software (three-month certification), SAP FICO, Oracle NetSuite, or QuickBooks.

Work with a Chartered Accountant and learn the job on the go. Tax filing, preparing files, data entry for GST returns, software and advisory support will help you learn the trade, and build your network. Learn how to use ClearTax or Winman software.

Learn Microsoft Excel (Advanced), Power BI or Tableau for roles such as business analyst, finance analyst, or MIS executive. Finance teams need people who can take raw numbers and turn them into charts and dashboards that management can understand.

Consider doing an MBA or

pursuing a professional qualification like CA, ACCA, CS, or CMA.

Meet a career counsellor for a personality/career profile to find what your interests are.

I have completed B.Sc. Maths. Should I pursue a PG degree or another course to get a job? Princy

Dear Princy,

The choice between academics and skills depends on what you want, age, current finances, and your appetite for theory versus application. First, the academic path. A two-year M.Sc. in Statistics/Data Science is a natural progression of turning your pure Maths skills into applied and high-paying skills as a data scientist or a statistician.

An MBA Finance or Business Analytics could give you a huge payoff in investment banking, management consulting, and product management roles. Actuarial Science (risk assessment for insurance/finance) is the gold standard for Maths graduates. A professional qualification, it is extremely difficult, but valuable.

The skills path can make you job-ready in 6-9 months. A certification in Data or business analytics certification with Excel (Advanced), SQL, Power BI or Tableau, and Python is one option.

Another is courses on financial modelling, valuation, and Mergers and Acquisitions on platforms such as Imarticus Learning, EduPristine, or the Corporate Finance Institute can lead to jobs such as equity research analyst or financial analyst.

Coding languages with strong Maths applications

such as Python (for backend/AI) or Java will work for jobs in software development and backend engineering.

I have completed a B.Sc. in Botany, but am not landing a job. I am not interested in further studies either. I have enrolled in online civil service coaching, but find it challenging. How can I get a job? Nayana

Dear Nayana,

What do you find challenging about the online coaching? Is it the syllabus, or are you just not interested? The UPSC is not for the faint hearted. If this is what you want, then you have to motivate yourself and persevere. If this is not for you, step away. Do not stay stuck in a loop of confusion and become demotivated.

You have a Science degree but have not matched it to a market need. Before you decide what to do, spend time to figure out what interests you and what you want to do with your life.

If you enjoy writing, then the fastest route is the content and communication path. You could be a content writer, science communicator, or subject matter expert for ed-tech companies. You can create question banks, write content for their apps, or explain concepts to students. Update your LinkedIn profile and look for academic writer or curriculum developer roles.

If you enjoy procedures, look for roles such as lab technician, quality control analyst, or quality assurance associate in food processing or pharmaceutical companies or diagnostic

labs. A short-term certification in Food Technology, Quality Management, or Good Laboratory Practices will make your CV stronger. But you can also join as a trainee.

Jobs like being an agri-input salesperson (selling seeds/fertilizers), or customer support for a scientific instrument company is also possible, as companies want graduates who can understand the technical side of their business.

I am in Class 10 and am planning a career in Finance. Can I choose Applied Maths in Class 11 and 12? Is it suitable for a finance-related career? Laya

Dear Laya,

Yes, Applied Maths is a smart choice for a finance-related career. The primary focus of Applied Maths is the practical application of mathematical tools to solve real-world problems in business, Economics, and Social Sciences. It will be a foundation for learning relevant topics such as Basics of Financial Mathematics, Index Numbers and Time-based data.

After Class 12, consider undergraduate programmes such as B.Com Finance, Bachelor of Accounting and Finance (BAF), B.B.A. Finance, Bachelor of Financial Markets (BFM), Bachelor of Business Studies (BBS). This can lead to exciting and rewarding roles such as financial analyst, investment banking, portfolio manager, risk analyst, data scientist and so on.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge

Books and ballots

Why political literacy must begin in the classroom

D. Praveen Sam

As the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Election 2026 approaches and the political climate across the state grows increasingly charged, with intensifying campaign rhetoric and closely scrutinised manifestos, a crucial question demands attention: Do our youth, especially students, understand politics beyond slogans and symbols? While electoral enthusiasm is visible, deeper comprehension often remains uncertain.

Superficial engagement

Although many young voters participate in democratic processes by voting, sharing opinions on social media, or engaging in campus discussions, such participation tends to remain superficial when unsupported by a structured understanding of political systems and institutions. As a result, their engagement, though active, is not always informed or critically grounded.

A related concern lies in the nature of student engagement itself. While social media has made political content widely accessible, it has also reduced engagement to memes, short posts, and reactive commentary. Consequently, students often hesitate to articulate nuanced opinions in public forums, either due to a lack of conceptual clarity or fear of criticism and polarisation.

Moreover, in the absence of guided spaces for discussion within educational institutions, critical dialogue is frequently replaced by passive consumption and thoughtful political expression gives way to simplified – and at times trivialised – repre-



sentations of complex issues.

Elective subject

This gap in political literacy is not incidental but systemic, as it stems from an educational framework that prioritises technical competence and employability while overlooking civic and political education. Consequently, students graduate with professional skills but without the intellectual tools required to function as informed citizens in a democracy. Since democracy depends not only on participation but also on the awareness and critical engagement of its citizens, educational institutions must assume a broader role in shaping politically conscious individuals. In this context, introducing politics as a course – or at least an elective – across disciplines becomes both relevant and necessary.

Such a course, if designed to remain non-partisan, can familiarise students with essential concepts, including the structure of government, the legislative process, and the role of bodies like the

Election Commission of India. At the same time, it can introduce regulatory frameworks that govern political activity, thereby enabling students to understand how public systems operate. Further, explanations of the roles and responsibilities of elected representatives, such as MLAs at the state level and MPs at the national level, and functions of political party members, can help transform abstract ideas into practical knowledge. This, in turn, allows students to evaluate leadership and make informed electoral choices.

Students must also begin to see themselves not merely as passive observers or occasional voters but as responsible stakeholders in democratic processes, whose voices, choices, and critical engagements have a tangible impact on governance and public life. When such a perspective is cultivated, participation evolves from a routine act into a conscious responsibility, thereby encouraging sustained involvement in discussions, decision-making, and civic action.

The inclusion of structured political education would not only encourage students to analyse political narratives critically but also foster a sense of civic responsibility. This will help bridge the gap between governance and the governed, especially among first-time voters, and contribute to a more informed and participatory society. At a broader level, the long-term impact of such education would be significant, as it would create a generation that is less vulnerable to misinformation and more inclined towards reasoned, issue-based discourse. Consequently, citizens would be better equipped to demand accountability and transparency, thereby strengthening democratic practices.

Why it's important

While concerns about the politicisation of education are often raised, they arise from a misunderstanding of intent. Political literacy is not equivalent to political indoctrination. Instead, it equips students with the ability to think critically about political processes, without prescribing what they should think.

As the elections bring renewed focus on governance and public policy, the need for political awareness among youth becomes increasingly urgent. After all, students are not merely voters but future leaders and decision-makers. Without a foundational understanding of politics, their ability to navigate complex realities will remain limited.

If democracy is to remain resilient and truly representative, it must be supported not only by electoral participation but also by sustained education. Only then can the journey from ballots to governance be guided by informed understanding as much as by civic engagement.

The writer is an Associate Professor of English at SSN College of Engineering, Chennai.



CAREER CUES
Richa Dwivedi Saklani

Being shortlisted for an interview by a university means the admissions team sees potential in you. Now the focus shifts from what you've done on paper to how you think, speak, and carry yourself. Let's break down what you can expect and how to approach it.

Common questions
“Tell us something about yourself”: The interviewers already have your basic information; so to tell them something they may not already know; something quirky, about your interests, or strengths you possess reinforced through examples.
Behavioural questions: This may be something like “Describe a leadership experience” or “Tell us about a time you failed”

or “How did you handle a disagreement?” Structure matters here. Use the STAR method: Situation (what was happening); Task (what was your responsibility?); Action (What did you do? The meat of the answer.); Result (What changed?) Keep it real. Interviewers are looking for how you think, not perfection. Even if the story is about weakness or failure, end on a positive note of how you are improving or working on it.

Subject questions: You will definitely be asked why you want to study the subject you are applying for. Avoid generic answers. Focus on an area within the subject that you want to pursue. Name an inspirational person from your field of interest and talk about a dream job. Be specific.

College questions: Why do you want to join this institution? This is a definite question. Go through the university website and identify course and faculty names within your programme.



Make your case

Tips to prepare for college interviews

Find out about clubs in the university. All this shows that you've done your research and know what you are talking about.

Body language
Your answers matter but that's not the only thing. Interviewers are also read-

ing your composure, your energy, and whether you seem like someone they'd want in their classroom. The basics – sitting upright, speaking at a steady pace, not fidgeting, eye contact – matter, but that's not what makes you memorable. It's the pause.

Most students are so afraid of silence that they rush into an answer before they've actually thought it through. A short pause shows composure and thoughtfulness.
If you don't know an answer at all, say so and that you would like to re-

search and get back.

On screen
The same principles apply in virtual interviews with an extra layer of technical awareness. Camera at eye level, neutral background, look into the lens when you speak rather than at

your own face on screen. The biggest mistake in a pre-recorded interview is being casual because there's no live interviewer. Record yourself, watch it back, and cut the filler words. Energy and warmth translate through a screen; don't leave them out just because the format feels mechanical. Whether it's in-person or online, treat it as a conversation, not an interrogation. They're not trying to catch you out. They're trying to understand how you think.

Difficult questions
A top liberal arts university once asked, “Do you think there should be a Me Too movement for men also?” The student got nervous, fumbled, and said, “Yes, because many women make false accusations.” He could not recover from this. Show nuance and empathy. Colleges want balanced thinkers, not extreme statements. What should the student have said? Something like this: “I think the core idea of the movement was to give peo-

ple a safe space to speak about abuse and that should apply to everyone, regardless of gender. However, we must recognise that the movement emerged because women have historically faced systemic barriers. So the big picture should be to build systems where anyone facing abuse can report it safely and be heard.” When faced with an extreme statement, always state both sides before voicing your own opinion.

Interviews are about clarity, curiosity, and authenticity. Preparation makes all the difference. Practise aloud, use real-life examples, know your subject and course so you have enough material to speak about. Most interviews will end with, “Do you have any questions for us?” Use this opportunity to ask them something too and demonstrate your interest.

With inputs from Kritika Malhotra

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public health impact, and its clinical relevance.

Interactive pedagogy
Interactive pedagogy does not have to be essentially entertaining but has to be engaging and have different approaches. Case-based discussions, simulations, visual atlases, narrative structures, and interdisciplinary teaching are just some ways in which the Medical Science curriculum can also be approached.

In the present context, we must recognise the need to bring innovation into classrooms even as we celebrate breakthroughs taking place in research laboratories worldwide. Science will not become easy, but teaching it shouldn't belong to an earlier age. The complex nature of Science and related subjects should invigorate students to think and challenge known knowledge rather than get bogged down by the anxiety of learning 1000 definitions.

Advancing Science is not only about discovering new answers, but also about ensuring that the next generation is equipped to understand, apply, and build upon those answers. If we keep pace not only with scientific progress but with how students learn, we strengthen the foundation of science itself.

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Build your inner infrastructure

When the world feels unstable, what is your internal load-bearing wall made of?



YOUR OWN GPS
Nivedita Das Narayan

Nudging towards the completion of your academic years, you wish time would slow down indefinitely. The looming uncertainty is overwhelming, and you feel unprepared. Seniors and guardians around you are uncertain, even cagey, as you look to them for guidance through this unfamiliar cycle. These are unprecedented times in your young lifespan.

Take stock
The wisdom of 'this too shall pass', and lived experiences of similar cycles in our history help keep things in perspective. Parallely, reinforcing your inner foundation, like shoring up a building's load-bearing walls to weather storms, is an opportunity. It begins with examining the building blocks that make your foundation. An audit – taking stock of your routines, skills, values, and emotional tools that hold you together to help understand what supports you and what needs strengthening – will give you the psychological safety to move forward. Much like a city assessing to invest in infrastructure to withstand against storms. Let's call this Inner Infrastructure.

When the world feels unstable, what is your internal load-bearing wall made of? When things spin out of control, it is reassuring to find some aspects we can control and influence. The good news is inner

stability can be built and engineered. Just as cities don't build drainage systems after a flood; young adults will need to build the inner infrastructure before crisis deepens, as a set of internal systems – not personality traits or talent – that are planned and deliberate. This idea is not productivity. Or about optimising. Optimisation is mostly possible when things are predictable. For volatile times you'll build internal capacity; the ability to feel and know each emotion that surfaces while continuing to function. Inner infrastructure is foundational; not facetious or the performative resilience of 'I am fine'/'I am strong' that populates our culture.

Non-negotiable values
What carries the load of tough cycles? Your non-negotiable values, habits and routines; the things you don't let wobble even when everything else does. Values shape our humanness and how we show up as a son, friend, employee, peer or a student, influencing choice between two hard(s), your decision to work hard, to focus and set boundaries. They're the load-bearing walls.

Practices that help regulate your emotions and nervous system; be it an active sport or consistent training at the gym, a habit of writing or reading, or playing an instrument, immersion in music as a listener or performer, grounding and breathing practices, and pausing to exhale when anxious, exposing the body to physical rigour in hiking or jogging that demands full engagement

with yourself. Every routine that is potentially the well-built drainage systems to process and release difficult emotions before they accumulate and flood you.

The important redundancy systems are the backup infrastructure of your selfhood, identity, and community so that no single loss breaks the chain. Building connections and lasting relationships makes community a part of your resilience infrastructure. It's a fact that individual grit only gets us so far. Who's in your web? Expanding your wing span beyond individual to the relational by reaching out to new connections, exchanging ideas beyond work, building co-dependent support networks, and practising interdependence as a strength are the legs that hold a structure through turmoil.

To me, Inner Infrastructure isn't stolidity. It's not 'be tough' or unflapability. It's a set of systems that can be learned, iterated, and improved upon. To me, this system you are building has three pillars:

Preparation: not for specific events, but for ambiguity itself; having thought through your Values and Non-negotiables before a decision is forced or hurried.

Self-management: the daily operating system (sleep, movement, attention hygiene, knowing your own depletion signals).

Emotional resilience: the drainage system; how you process, not suppress.

Infrastructure takes time and maintenance. This isn't a three-step fix and it looks different for each one of us: a cramped Mumbai flat and a quiet Coorg home require different architecture. You are building for the beyond and reinforcing the infrastructure; it is not a resolution from this anxious milieu but tools to ground deeper into your strengths and build capacity for and beyond this uncertain cycle.

The writer is a leadership and life coach, mentor and freelance writer. Email nivedita@lifealigncoaching.com

K.V. Leela

Every year, as educators, we have ample reason to celebrate various breakthroughs in research, new technologies, and expanding frontiers of knowledge. However, we must also pause to ask: are we doing our bit in ensuring that we, too, are evolving the way we teach Science?

Students today engage with visuals, ask questions in real time, and seek relevance. If we ignore this shift, we risk mistaking disengagement for incapacity. Therefore, we need to correct the mismatch between how we teach and how they learn. New-age learners respond to interaction more than unidirectional instructions. Yet, the majority of higher education curricula, especially in Medical Sciences, still rely on dense, text-heavy formats developed for an earlier generation that had limited access to other means of information.

Text heavy
Over the years, even capable students hesitate before even beginning certain topics not because they lack the ability but because they anticipate the worst possible complexity in a format that seems extremely intimidating. When a discipline is already terminology-heavy and layered with detail, the delivery can make a huge difference in either reducing or deepening anxiety.

While rigour is essential



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Change the delivery

Why we need to rethink the way Science is taught in higher education

in science, it does not have to mean rigidity. We need to evolve the way we teach and present complex information to a generation growing up on a 30-second reel format.

Emerging learning pedagogies and cognitive research indicate that learners retain information more easily and effectively when concepts are linked to relatable situations and stories. This makes the application of knowledge in practical life simpler for students. When they can see how pieces connect, knowledge becomes more personal and meaningful rather than just a mechanical discourse.

Build understanding
Future clinicians will be required to do more than just recall medical facts; they will need to recognise patterns, interpret findings, and apply knowledge under pressure. These skills need to be built on a deep understanding that students will gain when approaching their studies on a daily basis. But, to build this confidence, we need clarity. An example of this change is a recent initiative that explored presenting challenging scientific content through a visual and narrative framework. The intention was to reduce the psychological barrier that often surrounds difficult

topics. When the format felt approachable, student participation increased without any extra effort. Discussions became more dynamic; questions became more thoughtful. Why? Because the narrative-driven approach helped convert traditionally complex concepts into engaging, memorable learning experiences. Presented in the form of a comic book titled *Fungal Fantasia: India's First Indiana Jones-Inspired Comic Atlas of Medical Mycology*, is aligned with the WHO Fungal Priority Pathogens framework. It also helped undergraduate students relate to concepts of diagnostics,

From scores to substance

Rethinking MBA admissions in the age of AI

Gaurav Sarin and Dwarika Prasad Tiwari

As AI becomes more common, and sustainability changes the way managers work, B-school admissions are going through a structural change. Recent GMAC research shows that analytical thinking, tech skills, and moral judgment are increasingly valued along with traditional leadership skills. Therefore, admissions should consider more than just test scores to see how well one can use AI and solve real-world problems. An evidence-based admissions framework that considers AI fluency, problem-solving skills, and sustainability values can help organisations find candidates who can guide them through change and disruption.

Survey showcases
The GMAC *Prospective Students Survey 2025* disco-



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vered that 46% of potential candidates state that hands-on experience with AI is a must-have skill. The same survey shows decent demand for strategy, problem-solving skills, and aligning them with employer expectations. On the sustainability front, candidates are increasingly influenced by their future employers' commitment to the ESG policies and ethical business practices.

According to the GMAC *Application Trends Survey 2025*, widespread AI integration in MBA programmes and sustainabil-

ity are important. Around 63% of graduate programmes reported no formal AI policy in admissions, with only a small number embracing use of AI in application writing.

According to the GMAC's *2025 Corporate Recruiters Survey*, strategic thinking and problem-solving remain top skills with recruiters valuing knowledge of the AI tools in postgraduate students.

Research studies
According to recent research that investigated how LLMs behave in the

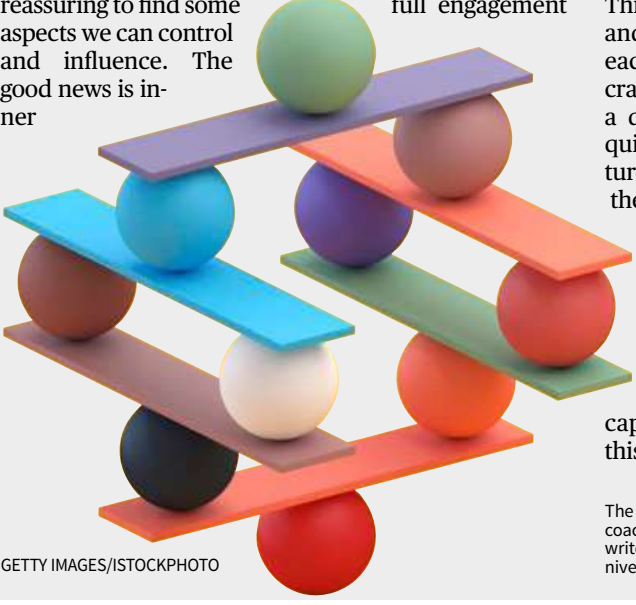
GMAT exam, some LLMs such as GPT-4 Turbo can beat average human intelligence. Another study, *Streamlining Admission with LOR Insights*, highlighted that an AI-based tool (LORI) utilises NLP to probe recommendation letters and calculate leadership traits such as teamwork, communication and innovation. The extensive research in Management Studies is increasingly concentrating on the intersection of AI, decision-making capabilities, and sustainability perspectives.

Strategies
Thus, admission units also need to strengthen their processes along with their priorities. First, applications should include video interviews or unscripted responses to assess authenticity and spontaneity, and reduce the risk of AI-generated essays. AI-assisted evaluation tools such as NLP can be used on letters of recommendation to evaluate pointers of leadership, innovation, and teamwork. Finally, they should describe and properly link an AI policy by allowing limit-

ed AI simulations or case-based challenges to assess candidates on real-world business problems rather than academic metrics and behavioural and situational interviews. This will help judge how applicants think under ambiguity, make trade-offs, lead, and design structured rubrics for strategic insights into long-term planning, systems thinking, and adaptability. The applicants' values and ESG ambitions can be assessed using descriptive prompts and interview modules focusing on sustainability.

Bringing graduate admissions in line with AI and sustainability is a strategic move, as data shows that students are increasingly considering hands-on AI experiences and sustainability in making their choice. This way, B-schools can not only train their students for the future but can also consolidate their reputation as leaders of high-quality, and contemporary Management education.

Gaurav Sarin is Chairperson MBA (AI and DS) and Dwarika Prasad Tiwari is Senior Manager Admissions, Branding and PR at TA Pai Management Institute.



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